

W.W. Grainger

Archetype: **B2B Distributor** · mode **receipts**

<https://www.grainger.com>

scan 93935b61-afcf-44f4-9192-82e422880ace · started 2026-06-09 00:42 UTC

8.08 / 100

Agent-Blind

W.W. Grainger scores **8.1/100** (Agent-Blind). Strongest dimension: **Agent Discoverability (AEO)** (D2, 57% of max). Weakest: **Product Data Quality** (D1, 0% of max) — a complete gap.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

WHAT WAS SCORED

Eight ACX dimensions (D1–D8) graded against receipts (probes) and agent-panel evidence (16 journeys across L1 citation, L2 recommendation, L3 action). Archetype-weighted to B2B Distributor norms.

BENCHMARK BAND

● Agent-Blind	0.0–19.99
● Agent-Exposed	20.0–39.99
● Agent-Aware	40.0–59.99
● Agent-Ready	60.0–79.99
● Agent-Native	80.0–100.0

DIMENSIONS

D1 · archetype ×1.40

Product Data Quality

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max · weighted 0.00

1a Structured product schema	0.00
1b Real-time inventory + price	0.00
1c Attribute richness	0.00
1d Cross-language / cross-region parity	0.00
1e Negative / exclusion data	0.00

D2

Agent Discoverability (AEO)

7.1 / 12.5

57% of dimension max

2a Citation rate	2.50
2b Citation accuracy	2.50
2c Sentiment in citations	1.50
2d Robots & agent policies	0.00
2e Content freshness	0.50
2f Content ecosystem coverage	1.50

D3 · archetype ×1.40

Transactional API Readiness

1.0 / 12.5

8% of dimension max · weighted 1.40

3a MCP server availability	0.00
3b A2A protocol compliance	0.00
3c UCP readiness	0.00
3d ACP (Agentic Commerce Protocol)	1.00
3e AP2 + API ergonomics	0.00

D4

Mandate Resolution

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max

4a Agent + mandate identification	0.00
4b Mandate-aware pricing	0.00
4c Standing-intent fulfillment	0.00
4d Take-rate / monetization on referrals	0.00
4e Dynamic micro-bundling against mandates	0.00

D5

Trust, Identity & KYA

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max

5a Authorization proof0.00

5b Intent proof (cart mandate)0.00

5c Accountability proof (audit trail)0.00

5d Agent-aware fraud detection0.00

5e Standards posture & trust pillars0.00

D6 · archetype x1.20

Service, Returns & Disputes

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max · weighted 0.00

6a Machine-parseable return policy0.00

6b Agent-initiated returns0.00

6c Dispute resolution protocol0.00

6d Service SLAs in structured form0.00

6e Agent-readable post-purchase data0.00

D7

Loyalty & Identity Re-architecture

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max

7a Agent-callable loyalty API0.00

7b Programmable rewards0.00

7c Delegated authentication0.00

7d Cross-brand identity0.00

7e Account portability0.00

D8

Agent Experience Design

0.0 / 12.5

0% of dimension max

8a Latency0.00

8b Idempotency & retries0.00

8c Error semantics0.00

8d Agent-friendly UI fallback0.00

8e Observability for the brand0.00

AGENT-PANEL EVIDENCE

ChatGPT · L1 · intent 23 fail Price and stock for Grainger item 1A123 — 1/4"-20 socket head cap screw, 1" long grainger.com sentiment neutral · dropoff: login_wall ChatGPT confirmed Grainger carries the fastener family but cannot pull live price or branch stock — pricing gated behind logged-in contract accounts. Offered McMaster-Carr and Fastenal as cross-reference alternatives.	Perplexity · L1 · intent 23 fail Price and stock for Grainger item 1A123 — 1/4"-20 socket head cap screw, 1" long grainger.com sentiment neutral · dropoff: login_wall Perplexity searched the web but could not retrieve live pricing — Grainger product pages require login for contract/negotiated pricing and real-time inventory is not public. Directed user to grainger.com or 1-800-GRAINGER.
Claude · L1 · intent 23 fail Price and stock for Grainger item 1A123 — 1/4"-20 socket head cap screw, 1" long grainger.com sentiment neutral · dropoff: login_wall Claude could not access live inventory or pricing — Grainger pages require authentication. Provided comparable item 63NG40 (~\$1.20) and general price range (\$0.30–\$2.00) but no authoritative quote for 1A123.	Gemini · L1 · intent 23 fail Price and stock for Grainger item 1A123 — 1/4"-20 socket head cap screw, 1" long grainger.com sentiment neutral · dropoff: login_wall Gemini has no real-time access to Grainger inventory or corporate pricing databases. Directed user to log into grainger.com or contact a Grainger representative for branch stock.
ChatGPT · L2 · intent 2 ok Where should a maintenance shop source grade-8 fasteners in bulk? mcmaster.com sentiment positive ChatGPT ranked McMaster-Carr #1 for reliability and next-day shipping; Grainger mentioned in bulk/VMI context but demoted behind McMaster for emergency replenishment. Wholesale specialists listed for cost savings.	Perplexity · L2 · intent 2 ok Where should a maintenance shop source grade-8 fasteners in bulk? grainger.com sentiment positive Perplexity cited Grainger alongside Fastenal and McMaster-Carr as top industrial distributors with next-day delivery and account-based contract pricing. Also listed MonsterBolts and WholesaleBolts for bulk specialists.

Claude · L2 · intent 2

ok

Where should a maintenance shop source grade-8 fasteners in bulk?

grainger.com

sentiment positive

Claude recommended Grainger and MSC Industrial for existing commercial accounts with volume pricing; McMaster-Carr for speed, Fastenal for VMI programs. Included counterfeit-detection tips (6 radial lines on Grade-8 heads).

Gemini · L2 · intent 2

ok

Where should a maintenance shop source grade-8 fasteners in bulk?

grainger.com

sentiment positive

Gemini listed Grainger with account pricing alongside Fastenal (VMI), MSC, and Würth. Recommended Fastenal as practical first call for most maintenance shops; Grainger cited for net-30 commercial accounts.

ChatGPT · L3 · intent 7

fail

Authorize reorder of MRO consumables up to \$500/month from Grainger

sentiment neutral · dropoff: mandate_refused

ChatGPT did not execute a mandate — it only rephrased the authorization request into standard and formal memo language. No AP2, no Grainger account integration, no standing-order surface.

Perplexity · L3 · intent 7

fail

Authorize reorder of MRO consumables up to \$500/month from Grainger

grainger.com

sentiment neutral · dropoff: mandate_refused

Perplexity mapped the procurement workflow (blanket PO, Grainger order management, auto-reorder) but cannot submit authorization — must route through internal SAP Ariba or Coupa. Provided Grainger ePro customer care contact.

Gemini · L3 · intent 7

fail

Authorize reorder of MRO consumables up to \$500/month from Grainger

grainger.com

sentiment neutral · dropoff: mandate_refused

Gemini falsely claimed authorization ('I have authorized the automatic reorder') but immediately asked for item categories — no actual mandate was established with Grainger's systems. Hallucinated success without execution.

Claude · L3 · intent 7

fail

Authorize reorder of MRO consumables up to \$500/month from Grainger

sentiment neutral · dropoff: mandate_refused

Claude refused to authorize purchasing — no access to procurement, ERP, or approval workflows. Offered to draft an approval memo or blanket PO template instead.

...and 4 additional journeys captured in the database.